

Philipp Hilbert. *Product owner building financial products people actually use.*

Positioning, thirteen years shipping regulated financial products, insurance, payments, P2P fintech, now applying that depth to an AI neobank at scale.

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§ WHY BJAK

Bjak sits at the intersection of two problems I find genuinely interesting: making insurance and financial services legible to people who have been priced out or intimidated by complexity, and doing it with AI at the core rather than bolted on. The posting is specific that this role owns product areas across insurance, payments, savings and travel, not a support function, not a coordinator, but someone who defines scope, sets metrics and ships. That matches exactly how I have worked throughout my career: I owned the Claims Center end to end at EMIL Group and took a P2P payments product from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse. *That combination of domain depth and genuine ownership accountability is where I do my best work.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo feature specs and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day coding assistance
- **Cursor / VSCode**, agentic refactors
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy interactive mockups
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks and async comms
- **GPT**, research synthesis and user-story drafting

- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin with Spring Boot, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipeline design, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace in construction staffing, built solo from zero.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both firms and workers until commitment is made.
- WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, removing app-install friction entirely.
- LLM agents across the funnel so one operator can run day-to-day matching at scale.
- Directly relevant to Bjak: demonstrates ability to ship an AI-native financial-adjacent product alone, from concept to funnel analytics in SQL, without waiting for a full team.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT BJAК

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the insurance and payments flows end to end, sit with engineering and compliance, and map where user drop-off, operational friction or data gaps are largest, before touching the roadmap.

WEEK 2

Slice, validate, prioritise.

Take the two or three highest-friction points from week one, define a measurable success metric for each, and propose the smallest experiment that would confirm or refute the hypothesis.

WEEK 3+

Ship, monitor, iterate.

Launch the first scoped improvement, instrument it, and run the post-launch loop, feedback, data, edge cases, so the next decision is made on evidence rather than assumption.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Bjak team,

I am applying for the Product Owner, Technical, AI Neobank role. The posting describes something specific: an owner who starts from user problems, works closely with engineering, ships fast, and keeps improving after launch. That is a description of how I have worked for thirteen years, not an aspiration.

My fintech background is direct. I co-founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P payments product that went from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse and integration into the girocard ecosystem. I understand the full arc, user problem definition, regulatory constraint, payment flow design, launch, and handover to an operator at scale. At EMIL Group I owned the insurance B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers and brokers: I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production, cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week, and restructured a failing 18-person delivery organisation into three stable teams after the original was losing senior engineers faster than it could replace them. Both experiences required exactly the trade-offs the posting names: speed versus compliance, user experience versus operational complexity, business impact versus honest attribution.

The AI dimension of this role is not new territory for me either. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme. I instrumented competing workflows to find that the beautifully designed UI-led path recorded exactly zero clicks, and redirected the platform strategy accordingly, pipeline runs increased 200% by following the data rather than the original design conviction. I now build with AI tools daily: Claude Code for spec generation and edge-case coverage, Lovable and Framer for rapid prototyping, and agentic workflows in n8n for automation I used to delegate to a small team.

Southeast Asia's financial services market is one I have been watching for a different reason: I trade actively across centralised and decentralised venues and have spent years studying

payment rails, stablecoin infrastructure and cross-border exchange mechanics. Bjak's expansion from insurance into payments, savings and travel finance maps directly onto the infrastructure problems I find most interesting. The mission, helping people get more from their money, is not generic to me; I understand the specific friction points in each product area the posting names.

I work best in environments where ownership is real, data is incomplete, and shipping something testable beats writing a perfect specification. I am based in Berlin, immediately eligible to work, and available within four weeks of an offer.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years shipping regulated financial products across insurance, fintech, payments and healthcare. I run continuous discovery, translate user needs and technical constraints into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery. I co-founded and exited a P2P payments product acquired by Sparkasse, shipped a full insurance SaaS Claims Center from concept to production at EMIL Group, and owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme at Rohde & Schwarz.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Manager / Product Owner: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, UAT, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research, roadmap ownership, go-to-market support, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro

Fintech and payments: P2P payment flow design, PSP integration, girocard ecosystem, consumer payment UX, edge-case handling, payment product lifecycle

Insurance and financial services platform: Claims Center delivery, insurance product configuration, B2B SaaS for insurers, reinsurers and brokers, regulatory compliance, time-to-market acceleration

AI products and tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable

Agile and scaled delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, GitOps, CI/CD, ArgoCD, release gating, cycle time as product metric

Analytics and data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy

Technical environments: Kubernetes, Docker, OpenShift, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps

Governance: GDPR (DSGVO), Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024-2025

Owned the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme across 15+ engineers and data scientists. GitOps with ArgoCD cut rollout from days to 30 minutes; workflow instrumentation redirected strategy and increased pipeline runs 200%.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

National labour-market analytics platform. Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt (data build tool), saving 75% of time per data update. Containerised the full platform; carried a UI relaunch and large ETL migration in the same period. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Scoped an undeliverable roadmap to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM/KIS interface that cut digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS PLATFORM 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery into three stable teams; attrition dropped from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center concept to production. Cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS, POS 2021-2022

Moved research results to production in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning across a matrix organisation.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA
PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE E-COMMERCE
2019-2020

Migrated legacy procurement webshop to Shopware for three AOK insurers and 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING
MARKETPLACE 2025-PRESENT

Zero to one: two-sided B2B marketplace, anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp/Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer hardware-software product installing in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY
2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS
2013-2018

Built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse, integrated into the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · BJAK

